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**TEACHERS' INFLUENCE IN CURRICULUM DEVELOPMENT IN
KENYA**

DANIEL VINCENT NYAMAI

MA EDUCATION (INNOVATION IN LEARNING AND TEACHING)

This Dissertation is being submitted in partial fulfillment of the Requirement for the
Degree of MA Education (Innovation in Learning and Teaching)

2020

UNIVERSITY OF SOUTH WALES

Abstract

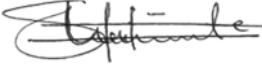
This study is about the influence of teachers in curriculum development in Kenya. Previous studies have shown that teachers, as primary stakeholders of the curriculum, are the key implementers of the developed curriculum. Not much is known about their influence in the development of the national curriculum. The study investigates the current level of teacher involvement in curriculum development through analysis of case studies conducted in Kenya in regards to teacher participation in curriculum development in Kenya. Further, the study investigates how the local curriculum governing body, Kenya Institute of Curriculum Development (KICD), can ensure full participation of teachers in curriculum development.

The study is a desktop research that adopted the use of qualitative methods of data collection and analysis. Documentary analysis was the main data collection tool that was used to analyze case studies for use within the study. Analysis of selected case studies was conducted and the use of thematic analysis and coding done to generate results. The study found out that teachers were inadequately conducted during the process of curriculum development in Kenya and most of them were not satisfied with the current curriculum development approach used by the KICD. It was further recommended that there was need for the KICD to adopt models of teacher involvement in curriculum development that would see that teachers fully participated in curriculum development.

Keywords: curriculum, curriculum development, teacher participation in curriculum development, teacher empowerment, role of teachers in curriculum development

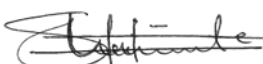
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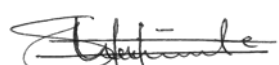
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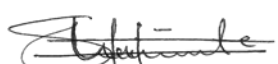
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CHAPTER 1: INTRODUCTION

This study explores the influence of teachers, as stakeholders, on curriculum development in Kenya. The education system is run by a curriculum, that defines the subject content for each unit studied, hence the curriculum can be literally seen as the operating system of an institution (Taylor and Richards, 2018). In his book, Warring (2018) indicates that the term curriculum is formed from the Latin word “Currere” which means a pathway or a racing path that one has to race through in order to achieve a certain set target. Henceforth, a curriculum can be defined as a formulated educational programme, through which the aims and objectives of a school or an institution are achieved. In order to keep up a curriculum with time, the curriculum needs to be dynamic. This means that it should be open to innovation and development, so that it does not run out of scope from its set objectives. Hence, a curriculum has got its own stakeholders who review it from time to time and propose changes according to the current trends in time.

Since the introduction of a competency-based curriculum in Kenya, there has been a keen interest in how it shall be developed over time. Several studies have investigated on teachers and curriculum development in counties within Kenya, even though we are not yet sure how their influence is perceived throughout the whole country. Teachers are very important players in curriculum development, and that is why they are termed as primary stakeholders. This study evaluated their purpose in the process of curriculum development in Kenya, and made recommendations for further practice.

1.1 Conceptual framework and background to the study

This study sought to evaluate teachers influence in curriculum development in Kenya. It is a secondary research, aimed at harmonizing several primary researches conducted in Kenya, in regards to the participation of teachers in the process of curriculum development. Many primary researches have been conducted in several regions in Kenya, mostly at the count and sub-county level, with the aim of investigating stakeholder participation in curriculum development in Kenya. This study evaluated the role of teachers as primary stakeholders in the curriculum development process, and sought to analyze their position and contribution in the curriculum development process.

Koskei (2015) indicates that all stakeholders play a big part in terms of their contributions towards developing the school curriculum. Teachers are classified under primary stakeholders, for they not only develop the curriculum, but also take part in its implementation. Their attitude towards the developed curriculum is a key factor that should be put to consideration for it determines the success of curriculum implementation. Alsubaie (2016) further indicates that teachers play a central role in any process of curriculum development that is undertaken. Teachers hold the task of introducing the curriculum to learners within the classroom meaning that their perception and understanding of the curriculum is very important towards successful implementation.

When the curriculum is developed by different stakeholders without their participation, then the implementation process becomes a challenge for they struggle to first understand its content before going forward to implement. This

makes it a very expensive and a time taking activity. Kenya adopted a new competency-based curriculum in January 2018 hence phasing out the former academic curriculum (Murungi, Wane & Muthaa, 2019). The new curriculum is in line with the vision 2030 development goals and will require the exploitation of the teachers' potential in its development and implementation. This study will form a basis for understanding the role of the teacher in curriculum development, and aid the education ministry in taking advantage of the teachers' contribution in developing the curriculum successfully.

Even though this study investigated the teachers' influence on curriculum development, it also recognized some other factors that may influence the curriculum development process. These factors may be political, social, economic, environmental or technological; for example, government policy, accreditation, expectations of the labor market etc. (Makaran, 2015). In this study, the relationship between these external factors and their influence on teachers' participation curriculum development were also considered. Minimal attention has been focused onto teachers' participation in curriculum development in Kenya. This study investigated the influence of teachers' in curriculum development and made recommendations on how their participation can be banked on to improve the national curriculum in Kenya.

1.2 Rationale of the study

Generally, this study evaluated the participation of teachers in the curriculum development process. It sought to outline how a nation, through its curriculum governing bodies can tap into the knowledge base of the teacher, and gain from

their involvement, as stakeholders, in curriculum development. Koskei (2015) concludes that, teachers in Kenya are rarely consulted when a new curriculum is being created or a current one is in development. More resources are spent by curriculum governing bodies on benchmarking from developed countries without making adequate consultations from the key implementers of the curriculum, who are the teachers.

At the same time, Alsubaie (2016) suggests that, "...there should be major advances in teacher development in order for teachers to actively reflect on society's needs in each stage of the curriculum development process" (p. 106). This means that as much as a nation will want to benefit from the teachers' influence in curriculum development, it should also invest in their development. As a framework for stakeholder involvement in schools in 21st century for academic excellence, Gichohi (2015), makes three recommendations which are that schools management bodies should consider setting up training workshops for all curriculum stakeholders, institute motivational programs to motivate stakeholders and finally that the education governors should consider strategizing on teacher development as it concerns their contribution in curriculum development. This study sought to justify one of her recommendations that the education ministry should put to consideration coming up with strategies for fostering the development of teachers so as to improve on the quality of their contribution in curriculum development (Gichohi, 2015, p. 20).

The study further justified the recommendation by Koskei (2015) that "... curriculum developers adapt participatory approach and involve teachers in

decision concerning their areas of specialty in order to improve acceptability and consequent effective implementation of curriculum innovations” (p. 86). The research findings of this study are aimed at not only improving the curriculum development process in Kenya, but also can be adapted and incorporated by curriculum governing bodies of other countries, especially developing countries where there are challenges in developing the national curriculum.

1.3 Purpose of the study

The purpose of this study was to create a framework for the incorporation of teachers in the curriculum development process. It created awareness by looking into the influence which teachers have on the curriculum, and identified ways in which they can help develop it. By researching on the contribution of teachers in curriculum development, the study further elaborated on the importance of continuous teacher development through trainings and workshops.

1.4 Research aims and objectives

Its main aim was to understand the teachers’ contribution in curriculum development in Kenya. It also sought to highlight the areas teachers can help improve on when seeking to model the curriculum to be better than before. The study further explored the following objectives:

- To determine the extent to which teachers’ understanding of the curriculum affects their contribution to curriculum development.
- To determine the extent to which teachers participate in curriculum development.

- To determine how teachers' participation in curriculum development can be improved on.
- To identify the best practices in curriculum development in Kenya.

1.5 Research questions

The following research questions were formulated in order to provide guides towards achieving the research objectives:

- What are teachers' opinions and understanding on the Kenya national curriculum and why do they hold those beliefs?
- How can teachers participate in curriculum development?
- What is the role of teachers in curriculum development?
- How do the different education levels of teachers affect their participation in curriculum development?

CHAPTER 2: LITERATURE REVIEW

2.1 Introduction

Curriculum development remains one of the most challenging practices, especially in developing countries like Kenya. Involvement of all stakeholders in curriculum development is also a challenge, as the work of curriculum development is left to professionals who determine most of the inclusions when developing the current curriculum. In her study Mulongo (2017) found out that incomplete consultation of all stakeholders brings in challenges in the curriculum implementation process, causing the developed curriculum to be underperceived hence implementation is poor. This chapter will review the relevant literature as it regards to teacher participation in curriculum development in Kenya and identify the relevant gaps in literature.

This study is based on the Taba model of curriculum development, created by Hilda Taba (Lunenburg, 2011). Hilda Taba, a curriculum reformer, believed that there must be a way of evaluating the impact of a curriculum on its target audience (learners) and as Fraenkel (1994) found out in his research; Hilda held her beliefs that teachers had sufficient knowledge of the students welfare hence they are the ones that should develop the curriculum. Teachers implement the curriculum from the grassroots and hence they are able to perceive the shortcomings of the current curriculum with ease and thus are able to propose positive amendments to the curriculum, that can result to a successful curriculum implementation process. As Lunenburg (2011) found out, the Taba model opposes the Tyler model in that it advocates for curriculum development to be managed from the grassroots whilst

the Tyler model advocates for a sequential and systematic curriculum development process. However, this study still embraces the Tyler model of curriculum development as the Tyler models addresses three factors influencing curriculum development. These factors include the conception of education essentially as experience, its approach to assessment as evaluation rather than as measurement and its approach to curriculum development as a problem (Walker, 1971).

2.2 Curriculum development in Kenya

Curriculum development in Kenya officially begun after Kenya became a republic nation in the year 1964 (Kinuthia, 2009). As Woolman (2001) indicates, a curriculum is usually subject to change since it prepares its audience to fit in the current economic, social and political society and thus it has to be innovated from time to time so as to keep up with the changes in the society. The developments in curriculum can be attributed to the changes or reforms that occur to the systems of education in place and can be instituted either externally or internally (Alsubaie, 2016). Internal changes to the curriculum can be instituted by primary stakeholders e.g. teachers, students, headteachers etc. whilst external changes to the curriculum can be instituted by secondary stakeholders e.g. parents, curriculum developers, educational governors etc.

Reforms within the curriculum target improvement, professional development, management, and innovation of the curriculum so that the curriculum lives up to the times that it exists (Alsubaie, 2016). Since becoming a republic, Kenya has changed its education system a total number of three times which begun from the year 1977, after the fall of the East African community, Kenya adopted a 7-4-2-3

curriculum system which later changed to a 8-4-4 system in 1985; and further on changed to a 2-6-3-3-3 system in the year 2016 (Muraraneza, Mtshali & Mukamana, 2017). These changes are proof that a curriculum is subject to change over time and that a curriculum can become obsolete such that it detours from the set objectives it was set to accomplish. When such a point is arrived at, it is the duty of curriculum developers to initiate plans to develop the curriculum, so that it is updated and works towards addressing the societal expectations of the curriculum.

2.3 Reasons for Curriculum Development

There are a variety of reasons that can contribute to the need for curriculum development. A curriculum can be developed either internally or externally and thus the reasons for curriculum development can emanate from either of the two places. Generally, as Gichohi (2015) indicated in her study, the environment or the society surrounding the institutions provides with reason for curriculum development. As much as the curriculum is meant for the development of the institutions, students and teachers; the curriculum also targets the development of the society in general.

Bunyi (2013) found out that the national curriculum plays a very important role in the development of the economy of a country. A curriculum will work towards addressing issues like environment, politics, climate change, sustainable development etc. and thus it is developed according to the needs of a particular country, so that it steers the learners towards working to achieve the national goals (Kinuthia, 2009). For instance, Kenya changed from the 8-4-4 academic curriculum model, to the 2-6-3-3-3 competency-based curriculum model so as to address the

issue of poverty through job creation in entrepreneurship (Mulongo, 2017). This shows that as much as the 8-4-4 curriculum model was in effect and was producing scholars, it was not addressing the needs of the country which aimed at eradicating poverty. Curriculum innovators had to model the curriculum to suit the national goals and thus a competency-based curriculum was put in place so as to enable the learner to develop both academically and professionally to the extent that they are able to embark on self-employment in case there aren't sufficient job opportunities within the country.

According to literature, some other reasons that back the need for curriculum development include: improving access to education, structural, organisational, systemic and pedagogical changes in the education system (Handelzalts, 2019). According to Handelzalts (2019) improving education access means that the curriculum is modelled so as to incorporate more learners with different abilities and being able to facilitate their education based on their interests. According to (Verger, Novelli & Altinyelken, 2018) improving access to education is in direct connection with the World Bank agenda on global education policy, and can be instituted through curriculum development.

Structural changes, as Mulongo (2017) puts it, is the overall rearrangement of the learning stages within an education system so as to fit a certain curriculum model. These changes are put forth by the national education ministry and can be as a result of the requirements of a new curriculum. For instance, when Kenya switched from an academic curriculum to a competency-based curriculum, the education administrators had to change the education system from 8-4-4 system to a 2-6-3-3

system, so that it could accommodate the requirements of the competency-based curriculum model. Makaran (2015) indicated that organizational change affected curriculum development mostly in higher education, in the case that a higher institution wanted to develop its curriculum. Some reasons attributed to that include the introduction of new courses or departments.

2.4 Motives for Teacher Involvement in Curriculum Development

In a study looking into the influence of teachers in curriculum development, it is quite important to look into the motives that may campaign for the participation of teachers in curriculum development. According to Kobiah (2016), when teachers are incorporated in the curriculum development process, it does not only improve on their self-esteem, but also the esteem of their students. Teachers hold the capacity to impose knowledge to students and it is through their interaction with students, that they are able to draw out best practices that can be inculcated into the curriculum to make learning more efficient. As Gichohi (2016) indicated in her research, participatory curriculum development is key towards achieving productivity, efficiency and other valued organizational goals.

Furthermore, teachers' involvement will not only improve on content but also the quality of decision making within the curriculum development process. Gichohi (2016) further indicates that involvement of teachers in curriculum development will give the development committee access to important information regarding the on-goings within the classroom setting as well as enhance teacher satisfaction with the curriculum content. The campaign for full participation of the teacher in curriculum development is therefore an important area for research. It creates

room for understanding the view of the curriculum by the primary stakeholders and how the curriculum can be approached from the grassroots during development.

2.5 Conclusion

From various research in literature by different scholars, it is evident that teachers hold a great consortium of knowledge, which is critical in the curriculum development process. Teachers operate at the grassroots, which means that they are the key facilitators of curriculum implementation. When the curriculum is gullible for the teachers, its implementation proceeds with ease, thus bringing forth improved performance from learners. Previous literature in curriculum development has shown that there is need for a research in teacher participation in curriculum development, and one of the ways of doing this is through investigating their influence in curriculum development. Current research agrees that teachers provide critical information useful in the curriculum development process; however, a continuation of current research in depth will help justify the influence of teachers in curriculum development.

CHAPTER 3: RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

3.1 Introduction

In the previous chapter, the study introduced curriculum development, its definitions and importance, and further reviewed relevant literature in regards to teachers' influence in curriculum development in Kenya. This research study is a desktop study that was developed using data collected from a variety of various secondary sources based on naturalistic study on the same area under research. Henceforth, this chapter will look into the research design adopted, the sampling strategy, the ethical considerations to the research method used and finally the justification for the suitability of the research approach used.

3.2 Research design

This study was a desktop research that was based on exploratory methods and was aimed at creating awareness for increased participation of teachers in the curriculum development process in Kenya. Hewson & Stewart (2014) define a desktop research (or a secondary research) as a kind of research that involves working with already existing data to develop and analyze new hypothesis. As compared to primary research which is based on working with raw data, secondary research works on the best available data which has been documented, and works with these data to develop a new research. Reiter (2017) recognizes exploratory researches as formulated researches that aim at building more on current research on a particular subject. These types of research usually work on current information on the subject and works towards filling in gaps in study so as to

provide a deeper understanding on a topic that was not explored to detail. Even though exploratory researches are not usually conclusive, Sherif (March, 2018) adds on that they provide with relevant data that had not been previously investigated on. As compared to descriptive researches which aim at answering a specific set of questions, exploratory researches are more flexible and provided with the vast range of teachers' academic backgrounds and varied approaches on curriculum development, they enable the possibility of analysis of this kind of data within the study. Exploratory researchers make more use of qualitative approaches to data collection, thus paving way to explore subjects into detail.

3.3 Sampling strategy

In order to gain a deeper understanding on teachers influence in curriculum development in Kenya, the research adopted a systematic literature review design to analyze selected sources for information. Walliman (2017) defines a systematic literature review approach as a kind of literature review approach that critically analyzes selected sources of data with an aim to provide clear information about a subject topic. The selected sources of information are mostly secondary sources, whereby data had been previously collected and documented by researchers. These sources include journals, books, cases studies, media reports and other literature. Published works on the influence of teachers on curriculum development in Kenya, were accessed via the use of internet databases including Science Direct, ResearchGate, Scopus, Web of Science and Google Scholar. The articles are peer reviewed meaning that one or a team of professionals have read through them and ascertained that they contain information that is suitable for publishing

and being referred from. Literature sources used in this researched was referenced using the Harvard Referencing method.

Sherif (March, 2018) adds on that a good systematic literature review should be clear and sourced from various secondary sources critiquing the information searched as well as providing with timeframes, when the data was collected. This provides with clarity and ease of understanding for the reader, as the aim of the research is to explore more on current research to improve on current knowledge. In this study, multiple secondary sources were searched using the explicit inclusion criteria, and data compared for similarities and dissimilarities. The explicit inclusion and exclusion criteria are a very important data analysis method, for it groups data researched on in different classes depending on how the authors presented their research findings thus providing a platform for the data to be compared (Ferreras-Fernández et al., November, 2016).

In order to determine the range of the research, the inclusion and exclusion criteria were set. Patino & Ferreira (2018) indicate that when the research question is posed, the inclusion and exclusion criteria are determined in order to set the scope and boundaries that the research will cover. They go on to add that the inclusion criteria set the characteristics of a subject that will qualify them to participate in the research; whilst the exclusion criteria, define the attributes of a subject that will factor out a subject from the research. In this study, the inclusion and exclusion criteria were implemented during the selection of data sources that were used within the study.

Key factors that were considered when selecting the studies to be used in the study were date, geographic location, participants and reported outcomes. The first step towards achieving this was through application of the inclusion and exclusion criteria in title selection and abstracts. The studies adopted were analyzed and checked whether their abstract declarations were in line or supported the current study objectives or supported. Curriculum development and teachers' involvement in curriculum development were some of the key phrases that were used in setting the boundaries of pilot studies to be included within the research.

Studies that met some inclusion criteria and some exclusion criteria were eliminated from the study. Studies that were based on curriculum development but were conducted outside the geographical setting of the current study, i.e. Kenya, were eliminated to avoid providing with conflicting information. However, studies that were conducted outside Kenya, but only addressed the importance of teachers in curriculum development were included since their objectives were in alignment with current research goals. The table below, shows the list of studies conducted within Kenya, that fit in the criteria for use and were sourced for information in regards to teachers' influence in curriculum development in Kenya:

Title	Author	Year
Assessment of Stakeholders' Influence on Curriculum Development Process in Secondary Schools in Kericho County. <i>IOSR Journal of Humanities and Social Science (IOSR-JHSS)</i> , 20(3), 79-87.	Koskei, K. K.	2015
Influence of stakeholders' participation in primary school management on academic performance: the case of Uringu Division, Meru County, Kenya	Kanana, M. R. E.	2015
Stakeholder involvement in Schools in 21st Century for Academic Excellence. <i>International Journal of Education and Research</i> , 3(2), 13-22.	Gichohi, G. W.	2015
Teachers' Participation in Curriculum Conceptualisation And Effective Implementation of Secondary School Curriculum in Kenya. <i>International Journal of Education and Research</i> .	Kobiah, L.K., & Njagi, M.W.	2015

Table 1 Case Studies

3.4 Data Analysis

The research adopted documentary analysis as a data collection tool used in qualitative analysis when a secondary research is conducted. Data analysis is the processing of going through and synthesizing data collected with an aim of obtaining meaningful information that can be used for decision making (Johnston, 2017).

In this study, data was collected from research papers, journal articles, web sites, and web blogs using the Internet and thus was analyzed using qualitative research methods. The case studies relevant to the current study were analyzed through generation of themes and codes that would draw out the required information from the selected studies.

3.5 Ethical considerations to secondary research

Secondary data sources can be harnessed to provide a basis for formulation of hypothesis that can be researched on. This saves on time and resources especially when conducting a research on a wide geographic area or a broad topic, that may take time to collect data on. Connelly (2014) defines ethical considerations as the steps undertaken within a study, that focus on ensuring that the process of data acquisition does not violate any legal procedures and policies as well as does not expose the information collected from the research to malicious use by third parties.

The first ethical approach implemented on this research was that the use of data from secondary sources was identified and referenced. This enabled the identification and acknowledgement of the owner of the original information. Data collected from secondary sources was analyzed for the identification of the methodology of data collection, accuracy, period of data collection, purpose for which it was collected and the content of the data (Connelly, 2014).

Further, the sources used in the study were reviewed to check whether the researchers of the respective studies had in anyway mentioned the names of the

participants of their studies. van Deventer (2009) indicates that studies containing identifying information on the respondents of the research need to be approached with caution and licenses to allow for the use of information from these sources need to be gotten. This study avoided the use of studies with identifying information on the respondents of the research to ensure that no ethical restrictions were broken.

Incomplete researches, on-going researches and researches that were based on other projects were avoided so as to avoid sourcing bias data or incomplete information. On the part whereby a research based on another research, the latter research (original research) was reviewed for eligibility and if accepted, sourced. Data available freely on the internet was checked whether the authors had agreed to permissions for further use and analysis of their work.

3.6 Justification of Data collection method

In order to understand the influence of teachers in curriculum development in Kenya, this study embraced documentary analysis, a secondary data collection method, to seek for information within existing data sources. Fitzgerald (2012) defines documentary analysis as a type of a qualitative research method whereby the researcher reviews several sources seeking to build up information around a certain topic. A researcher uses selected codes and further develops them into themes and thus they are able to come up with information that satisfies specific set hypothesis within a selected topic under study. For contemporary social scientists, documented data is very important since it saves on time used for collecting similar data from the field.

Since several studies had been conducted within different parts of Kenya in regards to stakeholder involvement in curriculum development, the results of those studies helped create a new perspective and a basis for this study. Works cited from other secondary sources helped build on the hypothesis for this study and thus cutting on the costs of using other methods of data collection e.g. interviews. Use of various data sources to support arguments in desktop research assists in increasing credibility of results arrived at (Sherif, March, 2018). Data from different studies is compared and consistent themes across the studies are drawn and the researcher uses this information to present more credible data.

CHAPTER 4: RESULTS AND FINDINGS

4.1 Introduction

This chapter will present the results and findings from the desktop research conducted on the influence of teachers in curriculum development in Kenya, through the use of documentary analyses where journal articles, books, documented case studies and websites with credible information related to the dissertation topic were sourced. Sources referenced were checked for being peer reviewed and were analyzed and checked whether they were either in direct relation or indirectly related to the subject title of this dissertation.

4.2 Analysis of Case Studies

4.2.1 Case study 1: Assessment of Stakeholders' Influence on Curriculum Development Process in Secondary Schools in Kericho County

Koskei (2015) conducted a study in Kericho county using a 5-Likert scale, where teachers were requested to provide opinions on their level of participation in developing the national curriculum. The study was aimed at measuring teachers' level of participation in curriculum development within Kericho county as well as provide opinions on their perceptions about the process of curriculum development in Kericho county.

From the study, with a rating scale of very high, high, moderate, low and very low, the ruling opinion was very low with 94.6% of the respondents supporting that opinion. The following graph indicates the results obtained in regards to the level of

teachers' involvement in curriculum development in Kericho county as drawn from Koskei (2015) research:

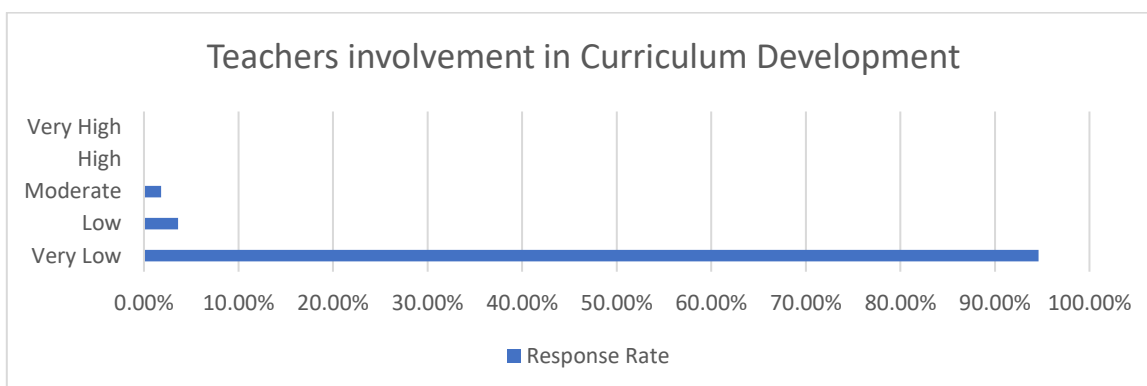


Figure 1 Teacher Involvement in Curriculum Development

From the study, with a rating scale of very high, high, moderate, low and very low, the ruling opinion was very low with 94.6% of the respondents supporting that opinion. With the rating 'low' taking the highest percentage implies that teachers were frustrated with the approaches that curriculum developers undertook when developing the curriculum under implementation in that time. Alsubaie (2016) indicates that teachers are the most important participants in curriculum implementation and it is through their experiences, competencies and practice that they are able to identify ways that the curriculum can be corrected or made better. The result findings in this case study however do not coincide with that statement, an implication that the teachers' influence in curriculum development at Kericho county was low.

4.2.2 Case study 2: Influence of stakeholders' participation in primary school management on academic performance: the case of Uringu Division, Meru County, Kenya.

This is a study undertaken by Kanana (2015) at Uringu Division, Meru County, Kenya with an aim of investigating the influence of stakeholders in primary school management on academic performance. Lunenburg (2011) defines stakeholders of an institution as the people or individuals from different aspects of the society who hold a positive interest in that institution and work towards ensuring that the institution fares better and achieves its goals. They include teachers, students, parents, local government authorities etc. The reason this case study was selected for analysis, was for the fact that the study in its objectives, investigated on the role of teachers in institution management and development.

From the literature review, it is evident that it is the duty of teachers to observe a student's content retention rates as well as their interests and learning patterns, then use these observations to make decisions on how to improve on practice. Makaran (2015) indicates that, when teachers are included in school management and decision making, there is a high chance that students will perform better academically. This is for the reason that when teachers make decision based on their competencies and practice, they work on filling the learning gaps that were not addressed by the curriculum.

The study involved the participation of 71 teachers amongst other respondents from institutions within Uringu Division and adopted the use of questionnaires with Five-Point Likert Scales as well as closed-ended questions. The correlation analysis was as shown below:

Table 2 Influence of teachers on school governance

		Academic Performance	Teachers participation in management
Academic Performance	Pearson	1	.429
	Correlation Sig. (2-tailed)		.000
Teachers participation in management	Pearson	.429	1
	Correlation Sig. (2-tailed)	.000	

From the results analysis, it is evident that involvement of teachers in management is directly related to increased academic performance in an institution. Shower (2017) indicates that at management level, teachers are able to use their class time observations and student learning patterns, and use this knowledge to formulate policies that when implemented lead to increased academic performance. Relatively, this study indicates that teachers were involved in management practices that included formulation of learning practices as well as in developing discipline policies.

Taylor & Richards (2018) further indicate that teachers usually have the will to participate in curriculum development, only that they are not involved. The study further found out that teachers were neither involved in budgeting nor organizing learning functions for students. With the teachers not participating in the setting of the mission and vision plans of institutions, teachers become demoralized and thus

they perceive the curriculum from an objectivist approach rather than a constructivist approach.

Wedell & Grassick (2017) define the objectivist approach as an approach that views the curriculum as passive (knowledge is passed from a central point) whilst the constructivist approach views the curriculum as active (knowledge is arrived at through practice and sharing). Teachers being the key implementers, hold the advantage of being able to note down a curriculum's downfalls and find suitable solutions to the downfalls with ease, as compared to other curriculum stakeholders.

4.2.3 Case study 3: Stakeholder involvement in Schools in 21st Century for Academic Excellence

Gichohi (2015) conducted a case study at Nakuru municipality, Kenya with an intention to investigate the roles that education stakeholders play in order to foster academic excellence within the municipality. In this study, stakeholders included students, teachers, school heads, parents, school boards and local education authorities. Gichohi sought to further investigate whether participatory management within the school by stakeholders can lead to increased academic performance by learners. The reason as to why this study was included within the current research is for the fact that it investigated the role of the teachers in management through developing learning practices that can be later adopted in the mainstream curriculum.

The study notes that despite increased funding for primary schools within Nakuru municipality, schools still continued to register poor performance in the national

examinations. Gobby & Niesche (2019) indicate that participation in school governance can be approached from two angles, one is through developing learning activities, setting up of student development goals, discipline policies and identification of challenges faced during classroom learning to find their solutions; two governance can be approached through managerial activities that involve budget allocation, planning for school functions, purchase of study material etc. Teachers participate in school governance through the first approach that involves understanding the student learning patterns and further using their competency and experience to develop learning practices that bring out a positive learning environment within the class.

Gichohi (2015) conducted a study from a range of schools, sorting them out from the least performing to the most performing, and got opinions from teachers in regards to their level of participation in school governance through development of learning practices and creation of classroom discipline policies. An adoption of the 5 – Likert scale (very poor, poor, fair, good, very good) was implemented to measure the level of teacher participation in school governance at Nakuru municipality, Kenya. The result findings for the study were as follows:

		Bottom Ranked		Middle Ranked		Top Ranked	
		F	%	F	%	F	%
Usefulness of the school committee structure	Very Poor	1	10.0	1	3.4		
	Poor			2	6.9		
	Fair	4	40.0	9	31.0	1	11.1
	Good	5	50.0	17	58.6	4	44.4
	Very Good					4	44.4
Total		10	100.0	29	100.0	9	100.0

Table 3 Teacher participation in school governance

From the table, it is evident that teachers from the bottom ranked schools or the poorly performing schools, held a poor, if not very poor opinion of their participation in school governance as compared to their counterparts from the performing schools who had a high opinion in regards to their inclusion to participate in school governance from their respective schools. Alsubaie (2016) indicates that teacher motivation can be achieved through empowerment of teachers by giving them the freedom to device their own teaching practices from class experience, which may in turn lead to improved performance of the students. When the teachers hold a high opinion of their own work, they perform their duties with increased valor and that is why the study recommends that school governing bodies need to device methods that will allow the inclusion of the various stakeholders in school management.

4.2.4 Case study 4: Teachers' Participation in Curriculum Conceptualization and Effective Implementation of Secondary School Curriculum in Kenya.

Kobiah & Njagi (2015) conducted a study in Meru and Nairobi counties in Kenya, with an aim of investigating whether there was a relationship between teacher participation in curriculum conceptualization and effective implementation of the secondary school curriculum in Kenya. McLean & Ashwin (2017) define curriculum conceptualization as the process of defining the requirements of curriculum, setting them in their order of implementation and then combining them to form a curriculum. This can be basically be seen as the process of curriculum development. This study was formulated in order to see whether there was any feasible relationship through teacher participation in curriculum development and the successful implementation of the curriculum.

The reason as to why this case study was incorporated in this research was due to the fact that it explored the participation of teachers as primary stakeholders and further identified the influence of teachers in both curriculum development and implementation in Meru and Nairobi counties of Kenya. In those counties, the study adopted the use of stratified random sampling with a target of 3146 secondary school teachers whereby the use of questionnaires for teachers was implemented as the main data collection tool. Further, the questionnaires used the Five – Likert scale questions (greater extent=5; Some extent=4, Undecided = 3; To a small extent = 2 and Not at all =1) to measure the level of teacher participation in curriculum conceptualization. The table below shows the results findings with the average score calculated under each query:

Table 4 Teacher Participation in Curriculum Conceptualization

Teacher Participation	N	M	SD
Participated as a member of curriculum project team	272	1.90	1.40
Assessed the weaknesses of the current curriculum	272	1.96	1.32
Suggested the needs of society and learners	272	2.31	1.52
Acted as a curriculum subject specialist	272	1.90	1.40
Helped to determine the philosophy of education	272	1.60	1.22
Helped determine the broad goals of education	272	1.74	1.27
Participated in Curriculum discussion sessions on quality of education	272	2.24	1.52
Overall mean	272	1.96	1.09

N=Sample size, M= mean, SD= Standard Deviation

From the figure above, the average score of 1.96 is evidence that generally there was little involvement of teachers in curriculum conceptualization since the score was below the median point 2.50. The score of 1.90 zero in the query that inquired about the teachers participating as members of a curriculum project team is evidence that the current curriculum had little or minimal involvement of teachers in the developed curriculum. This could have adverse effects in curriculum implementation since the low score is evidence that teachers had no knowledge of what composed the developed curriculum.

A study carried out by Mwanza (2017) with an aim of investigating the teacher involvement in curriculum development in Zambia, concluded that teachers who were not in any way involved in the process of curriculum development, felt

alienated by the developed curriculum and usually had a hard time during curriculum implementation. Handler (2010) perceives teachers as curriculum leaders and proposes that the proposed curriculum draft should go through the hands of the teachers for testing and feedback so that there may not rise challenges during curriculum implementation. Kobiah & Njagi (2015) further argue that it is through teacher involvement in curriculum development that they become familiar with the developed curriculum thus accepting it as their own invention. When teachers have a positive attitude towards the developed curriculum, implementation becomes easier since they master the curriculum concepts with ease hence implementation is more effective.

In the study, teachers proposed creation of panels in an underlaying system that work towards the incorporation of teachers in curriculum development. Through creation of workshops and planned training in seminars, teachers are able to document successful practice that can be set for inclusion in the curriculum during the development process and thus making the curriculum better from time to time. For example, in the United Arab Emirates Troudi & Alwan (2010) indicate that through teacher involvement in the transformation of the curriculum teachers are able to lay down strenuous education practices that increase the workload within the curriculum and represent them with improved practices that are less strenuous and aid them in covering the syllabus in time.

Generally, the study was able to find out that teachers have got a lot of untapped potential in Kenya and if well included in the curriculum process then the developed curriculum could be robust and easy to implement. Curriculum

governing bodies in Kenya, and mainly the KICD needs to take more divergent measures towards the inclusion of teachers in curriculum development, for it is through participatory curriculum development that the developed curriculum is easily implemented.

4.3 Summary

Curriculum development is an ongoing process and thus the creators of a curriculum need to work on it together so as to ensure that the curriculum is not only updated but also it entails the content contributed by all stakeholders. Kaviti (2018) indicates that for a curriculum to be able to fully address its goals, it must first be accepted by teachers who are the key implementers of the curriculum. The goals of curriculum development in Kenya includes ensuring that the national curriculum is in line with the country's vision (Kaviti, 2018) and models the learners towards being productive members in the society.

However, to achieve this the learner's interests and expectations from the education system must also be put into consideration. Learners have different abilities and talents that need to be developed through careful modelling by the tutors. Being different also implies that learners have different learning patterns. It is the duty of the teachers to observe these patterns and be able to cater for their students by putting them into nurture groups where they can observe them keenly (Handelzalts, 2019). Through continuous successful practice teachers are able to come up with learning practices that when incorporated into the curriculum increase the chances of successful curriculum implementation.

CHAPTER 5: CONCLUSION

In light of this study, it is evident that teachers have a great influence in the process of curriculum development in Kenya. The study has divulged that teachers constitute the primary stakeholders in the curriculum development process and thus they hold great knowledge that when inculcated into the curriculum, implementation becomes less tedious. Furthermore, the literature review addressed the history of curriculum development over time in Kenya since the institution of formal education in the country, and expounded more on the importance of curriculum development.

Teachers were seen as agents of change within the curriculum development process in that they observed and evaluated the changing needs of the students with time whilst formulating practices that need be induced into the curriculum to address these changes. By going through the literature review and the findings of the secondary research, this chapter will address the conclusions arrived at from the study.

5.1 Empowerment of Teachers on their Participation

From the research findings, it is evident that the teachers are not empowered as it concerns their role in the curriculum development process. Teachers are left with the idea that it is the role of government bodies and professionals to conduct research on the changes that need to be included and further implement them without any further consultations (Koskei, 2015). A report in *The Standard* newspaper by Oduor (2019) indicates that the recent upgrade from the academic

curriculum to a competency-based curriculum in Kenya has been seen as a great move towards achieving the goals of the country, however, it has recently faced some opposition from the local teachers' unions due to poor consultations between stakeholders of the curriculum.

The mandate of developing the Kenyan education curriculum has been left to the Kenya Institute of Curriculum Development, with the expectations of facilitating the participation of all stakeholders in the curriculum development process (Kicd.ac.ke., 2020). Despite the body having the vision of the country in line in the changes implemented in the new curriculum, Kobiah and Njagi (2015) indicate that teachers still felt that they are rarely consulted when most of the changes were being instituted. It is not surprising to find that teachers through their unions show defiance to some of the policies being implemented within the curriculum.

This is a good indicator to show that teachers as stakeholders of the curriculum were not aware when these developments within the curriculum were taking place. Other studies by Gichohi (2015) and Kobiah (2016) show that teachers are not informed on their participation in the curriculum development process. There is need to empower teachers with information on how they can draw practices that can be debated for inclusion in the developed curriculum.

Gichohi (2015) stipulates that there are big performance gaps between schools in various counties Kenya. This is a direct show that practices being carried out in performing schools are not being documented for inclusion in the developed curriculum as well as lessons learnt from the less performing schools are not being sought solutions for. Aligning the curriculum with the country's expectations is a

commendable action taken by the curriculum experts, however Kobiah (2016) adds that the pedagogical knowledge needs to be included and this can only be achieved through empowering teachers to participate in curriculum development.

5.2 The KICD and the role of teachers in curriculum development

The research findings identified the Kenya Institute of Curriculum Development as the body in charge of facilitating stakeholders in participating in curriculum development (Ng'asike, 2018). Teachers as primary stakeholders, are not aware of their role in curriculum development and thus their participation in developing the curriculum is minimal. Oduor (2019) adds that there is need to improve the relationship between the curriculum governing body and the teachers so as to come up with strategies that will lead to teachers' propositions being induced in the developed curriculum.

If the result findings of Koskei (2015) in Kericho county are to be generalized to the whole country level, then it implies that teachers are rarely consulted when the national curriculum is being developed. This calls for the KICD to adopt one of the two models of teacher involvement in curriculum development as outlined by Shaver (2017) which are Curriculum Development at the Central Level and Curriculum Development at the Local Level. If any of the two models is to be adopted, then there should be proper training on how each model can be approached depending on its suitability.

Shaver (2017) indicates that curriculum development at the local level will imply that teachers will participate at curriculum development at the school level,

whereby their propositions will act as supplements to the already developed curriculum. By definition, this method is easy to implement, however, the supplements may not work well with the components of the main curriculum since the components remain constant, and are never changing whilst the supplements are variables. This may lead to misunderstandings between the teachers and the curriculum developers since the former is undermined in this process.

On the other hand, Shawer (2017) indicates that curriculum development at the central level will involve teachers' propositions being included within the developed curriculum. Wedell & Grassick (2017) add that this process is time taking and resource demanding, however the developed curriculum is easier to implement with a higher success rate as compared to when teachers participate in curriculum development at the local level. It is not evident on which of the two models the KICD has adopted from the responses provided by teachers.

5.3 Recommendations

The following recommendations were made from the research findings:

- There is need for the Kenya Institute of Curriculum Development to consider creating training programs and workshop programs to educate teachers on how they can document practices that can be proposed for inclusion in the developed curriculum. This will help the teachers understand what the curriculum constitutes and how they can make it better.
- The Kenya Institute of Curriculum Development should also consider adopting one of the teacher inclusions to curriculum development models so

that teachers are aware of the practices to undertake towards ensuring that their propositions feature in curriculum implementation.

- The Kenya Institute of Curriculum Development should also consider creating a plan for equal participation of all stakeholders in curriculum development, since the harmonization of all the propositions made by the stakeholders will result to a better curriculum as compared to when the curriculum is developed by a fraction of the stakeholders.
- The government of Kenya should also consider devolving the curriculum development process so as to ensure that there is equal participation of all stakeholders at the county and subcounty levels. This will ensure that there is increased participation of stakeholders and the process of curriculum development is more informed and thus the acceptability score of the curriculum in the society increases.

5.4 Suggestions for further research

This study was limited to the influence of teachers in curriculum development in Kenya and the results cannot be generalized for other stakeholders. The study suggests that similar studies to be conducted for the other stakeholders in Kenya. It also suggests for further studies to be conducted on the most appropriate model that the Kenya Institute of Curriculum Development can adopt to ensure that teachers are able to participate in curriculum development.

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APPENDICES

Appendix 1: Dissemination

From the study, it was evident that as primary stakeholders, teachers hold a lot of potential that can be used to develop the national curriculum in Kenya. As the primary implementers of the curriculum, it is recommended that teachers needed to be fully inducted into the process of curriculum development so that they could own the developed curriculum and implement it as their own devised project. This study is aimed at creating the awareness for the importance of developing a curriculum that factors in the input of teachers. It recognizes and appreciates the purpose of teachers in child growth and development and further adjudicates for the need of including teachers in curriculum development.

The audience for this study is: Kenya Institute of Curriculum Development (KICD), teachers and general public. The researcher, will seek to make the study known to the audience through the use of social media, open research websites like ResearchGate and Academia, journals and publication in the University of South Wales journals website.